

Option D - Equal Founder Optics + Build Option

This is a discussion draft, not a legal agreement or legal advice. Not legal advice. It builds on Option B but adds a founder-equity structure designed to keep Vlad visibly protected while keeping Razim protected for the build, product, and model execution.

Plain-English summary

Investor receives a paid exclusive build/investment option. Razim keeps IP during the option period. Vlad and Razim are both treated as meaningful founders, but their economics vest against different contribution risks: Razim against product/build/model delivery, Vlad against investor/commercial delivery. Investor can increase ownership by funding defined milestones rather than receiving automatic personal equity transfers from Razim.

Commercial purpose

This route is best when Vlad needs founder-level recognition for originating and developing the relationship, and investor wants a clear path to larger ownership later. It avoids presenting Razim as above Vlad, while still making sure equity is earned against actual delivery.

Indicative starting structure

Table:

* Holder | Headline allocation | Initial recognition | Vesting or increase basis

Razim | 30%-35% | Current build, product, model, docs, and demo work | Product, model, MVP v2, evidence, and delivery milestones

Vlad | 25%-30% | Relationship origin, investor access, commercial development | Funding close, pilot/customer introductions, partnerships, revenue milestones

Investor | 30% | Stage 1 funding and option/investment commitment | Additional funding/data/model/platform milestones

Option / contractor pool | 10% | Reserved | CTO, ML contractors, engineers, advisors, future hires

The exact percentages are for discussion only. Counsel should convert the chosen structure into a proper term sheet.

What investor gets

- Paid exclusive option to invest in or acquire Fieldstate within a defined period.
- A cap-table structure that keeps both key originators aligned.
- A path to larger ownership by funding larger milestones.
- Defined demo/pilot usage rights during the option period.
- Milestone visibility and optional source/code escrow if substantial build funding is provided.

What Vlad gets

- Founder/commercial recognition, not just introducer treatment.
- A meaningful headline stake or allocation.
- Commercial upside tied to delivered outcomes.
- Protection from being squeezed out after bringing the relationship together.
- Information and anti-selective-dilution protections to be agreed in company documents.

What Razim keeps/protects

- Ownership of Fieldstate IP during the option/build period.
- Founder economics for current build contribution and continued technical/product delivery.
- No automatic personal equity transfer to investor or Vlad.

- Retainer for delivery time.
- Background tooling carve-out and no broad non-compete.

Indicative cost breakdown

Table:

* Item | Indicative range | Notes

Option fee | GBP 15k-25k | Paid for exclusivity/first right; may be credited against later investment or buyout.

Option period | 60-90 days | Extension requires additional fee or written agreement.

Founder/operator retainer | GBP 10k-18k/month | Paid to Razim for active technical/product delivery during option period.

Commercial/founder compensation | To be agreed | Vlad compensation can be equity, commission, retainer, or milestone warrants depending on role.

Stage 1 sprint/build fee | GBP 25k-50k | May be separate or rolled into retainer/sprint milestones.

IP transfer/buyout | GBP 250k-750k | Applies if option converts into acquisition/assignment rather than NewCo founder-led route.

Contractor/neural budget | Separately funded | Advanced ML, neural models, data licences, GPU runs, CTO/engineers are company-funded resources.

Milestone ladder

Table:

* Milestone | Investor upside path | Vlad upside path | Razim protection

MVP v2 funded | Initial option/investment rights activate | Initial commercial founder recognition | IP remains with Razim unless NewCo/assignment terms complete

First paid pilot | Investor may receive pre-agreed warrants or conversion rights | Vlad earns commercial milestone vesting | Razim retains founder/product lead role and retainer

Licensed data/model budget funded | Investor can purchase/earn additional equity through funding round or warrants | Vlad may earn upside if he sources commercial/data partner | Advanced specialists funded by company, not by reducing Razim only

Neural model campaign funded | Investor receives larger opportunity via priced round/convertible/warrants | Vlad upside tied to partnerships/revenue, not passive holding alone | No automatic equity transfer; dilution is pro rata or from agreed pool

Commercial platform funded | Investor may move toward larger control through fair financing | Vlad settles into commercial role or board/advisor role | Razim can step down toward long-term stake only if company is staffed and funded

IP mechanics

- Razim owns Fieldstate IP during the option period.
- Investor receives only defined demo/pilot usage rights during the option period.
- Razim agrees not to sell, assign, or exclusively license Fieldstate to another party during the option period.
- If the option converts into NewCo, IP moves into NewCo only after founder/investor documents are agreed.
- If the option converts into assignment, IP transfers only after full payment or escrow release.
- If the option expires unexercised, exclusivity ends and Razim retains all rights.

Equity mechanics

- Razim and Vlad may have near-equal founder optics, but vesting should reflect different contribution categories.
- Investor additional upside should come through warrants, priced rounds, convertible instruments, or agreed pools.
- Future dilution should be pro rata unless a pre-agreed option/commercial pool is used.
- Razim should not be the only source of investor or Vlad upside.
- Contractor/neural hires should be funded through company budget, option pool, or contractor pool.

Investor protection

- Paid exclusivity gives investor first shot.
- Milestone ladder shows how larger funding can earn larger opportunity.
- Founder vesting keeps both Razim and Vlad aligned.
- Defined demo/pilot rights let investor test commercial use.
- Escrow can be added for substantial funded milestones.

Razim and Vlad protection

- Both founders get explicit roles and contribution-linked economics.
- No selective dilution through related-party share issuance without agreed protections.
- Pre-emption, information rights, and reserved matters should apply to both founders.
- IP sale, exclusive licence, or assignment should require agreed consent/protection.
- Removal without cause should not let the company keep all contribution value while stripping founder economics.

Open issues for counsel

- Whether this is best structured as option, SAFE/convertible, warrants, or NewCo term sheet.
- Founder vesting design for Razim and Vlad.
- Commercial milestone definitions for Vlad.
- Product/build milestone definitions for Razim.
- Anti-dilution versus pre-emption and reserved-matter protections.
- Assignment, licence, escrow, and background-IP carve-out language.

Counsel review note

This draft is for commercial discussion only. It should be converted into proper option, investment, shareholder, IP, and services documents by counsel before signature.